

Web Portfolio Design Contract

Working Specification for a Policy-Oriented Analytical Portfolio

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1. Purpose of the Contract

This document defines the design contract for a web portfolio intended to be shared through a CV link.

The portfolio will present a hybrid analytical profile combining data analysis, economics, policy analysis, modelling, visualisation, and project-based research. It will not function as a generic personal website. It will function as a curated analytical platform where selected projects demonstrate the capacity to move from complex questions to structured data work, visual outputs, interpretation, and policy-relevant communication.

The portfolio will be designed primarily for recruiters, while remaining credible for economists, researchers, and technical reviewers.

2. Core Positioning

The portfolio will position the author as a hybrid analytical profile able to work across data, economic reasoning, policy interpretation, and technical modelling.

The homepage will use a short institutional-style statement aimed at recruiters. The statement should be direct, professional, and immediately legible.

A possible baseline positioning statement is:

Analytical work on economic systems, climate transition, public policy, and data-driven decision-making.

The statement should avoid overly academic, poetic, or abstract wording. It should make the profile understandable quickly without reducing it to a single narrow job title.

3. Target Audiences

The portfolio will serve two audiences.

3.1 Recruiters and HR Readers

Recruiters should understand within one minute:

- what type of analytical profile is being presented;
- what kinds of problems the author can work on;

- what technical and policy skills are demonstrated;
- which selected projects best evidence those skills;
- how the portfolio supports the CV rather than duplicating it.

3.2 Economists, Researchers, and Technical Readers

Technical readers should be able to inspect:

- the analytical question behind each project;
- the data and methodological logic;
- the modelling or visualisation choices;
- the limitations of the work;
- the reproducibility or export logic where relevant.

The portfolio will therefore keep technical depth present but secondary on the homepage. Technical details may be made available through project pages, expandable panels, appendices, or linked static exports.

4. General Communication Principles

The portfolio will communicate through clarity, structure, and selective depth.

It will avoid excessive self-description. It will be project-centric. The author's personal presence will remain minimal, limited to a short professional introduction and contact links.

Each project will be framed as an analytical object. Depending on the nature of the project, it may be presented as a research project, an analytical case study, a policy investigation, a technical tool, or a systems observatory.

The portfolio will avoid generic claims such as “passionate about data” or “interested in innovation”. Claims should be evidenced by projects, outputs, methods, or visual artefacts.

5. Structural Principles

The portfolio will use a card/grid project exploration model. The structure should support browsing rather than forcing users through a single long narrative.

The basic structure will remain flexible enough to accommodate future projects and small adjustments.

5.1 Homepage

The homepage will include:

- a short institutional-style hero statement;
- a concise profile positioning paragraph;
- selected project cards;
- a compact skill and method snapshot;
- links to CV, contact, and selected outputs.

5.2 Project Index

The project index will use cards or tiles. Each card should include:

- project title;
- short problem statement;
- methods used;
- output type;
- policy or analytical relevance;
- link to the full project page.

5.3 Project Pages

Each project page should follow a stable template:

1. Problem
2. Why it matters
3. Data or material used
4. Method
5. Key outputs
6. Main insight
7. Limitations
8. Static exports or interactive visuals

The template may be adapted depending on the project, but the logic should remain consistent.

6. Visual Identity

The portfolio will use a calm, designed, institutional visual identity.

It will avoid a bright white academic-report aesthetic. The design should feel polished, calm, structured, and information-rich, without becoming decorative or heavy.

The preferred direction is:

- dark-mode-first;
- muted, low-glare backgrounds;
- structured panels and cards;
- restrained accent colours;
- high readability;
- charts integrated visually into the page;
- institutional rather than personal branding.

The portfolio should feel closer to a policy intelligence platform or analytical observatory than to a personal blog or generic developer portfolio.

7. Colour Palette

The default palette will be sober and accessible.

Use	Suggested Hex	Role
Main background	#111827	Dark slate background, low-glare base
Secondary background	#141A1F	Alternative warm-dark background
Panel background	#1E2933	Cards, visual panels, content blocks
Elevated panel	#202A33	Hovered cards or highlighted sections
Main text	#E6E1D8	Soft off-white text, less aggressive than pure white
Muted text	#A8B0B8	Secondary text, captions, metadata
Primary accent	#7FB3A6	Muted teal for links and highlights
Secondary accent	#D9A441	Muted amber for selected emphasis
Tertiary accent	#7A8FBF	Desaturated blue-purple for secondary comparison
Inactive elements	#4B5563	Disabled, secondary, or non-selected elements

Colours must not be used as the only carrier of meaning. Labels, ordering, line styles, icons, or annotations should support colour-based distinctions.

8. Typography Rules

The typography should be standardized, elegant, and readable.

The recommended direction is a modern sans-serif base typeface, with optional subtle serif use for selected headings if it improves the editorial feel. The implementation should prioritize consistency over experimentation.

Typography should follow these principles:

- strong hierarchy between headings, section titles, card titles, body text, captions, and metadata;
- no excessive font variety;
- no decorative display fonts;
- body text should remain readable on dark backgrounds;
- technical metadata may use monospace accents sparingly;
- headings should feel institutional, not startup-like.

9. Chart and Visualisation Philosophy

The portfolio will use few charts, but each chart should be highly polished.

Charts should be treated as central analytical objects, not decoration. Each chart must answer a clear question.

The preferred visual hierarchy is:

1. finding-based title;
2. short interpretive subtitle;
3. polished chart or diagram;
4. short caption;
5. optional technical note.

The portfolio should foreground the following visual families:

1. networks and flows;
2. systems diagrams;
3. time trajectories and transitions;
4. policy scenarios.

Maps, tables, and secondary metrics may be used where relevant but should not dominate the visual identity.

10. Chart Export Standards

The portfolio will distinguish between static exports and interactive visuals.

10.1 Static Exports

Static exports will be used for:

- CV-linked project previews;
- publication-style figures;
- downloadable project outputs;
- social or professional sharing where needed.

Static charts should be exported in website-friendly and publication-friendly formats where possible.

Preferred formats:

- SVG for vector graphics;
- PNG for fast web previews;
- PDF where publication or documentation use is expected.

10.2 Interactive Visuals

Interactive visuals will be used where exploration improves comprehension. They should allow users to inspect charts and diagrams fluidly.

Expected interaction features include:

- zoom;
- pan;
- expand or fullscreen mode;

- hover details;
- selective filtering where relevant;
- smooth movement between overview and detail.

The interaction should feel polished and public-facing. It should not feel like an exposed notebook, debugging interface, or raw analytical pipeline.

11. Interaction Philosophy

The portfolio will be mostly static, with selective interactive elements.

Interactive simulations and scenario sliders may be used for projects where they add interpretive value. They should be designed as polished public-facing simulations, not as technical notebooks.

Interaction should support understanding. It should not be used for visual spectacle.

Animations, when used, should be restrained. They may support transitions, reveals, hover states, or scenario changes. They should not distract from analytical content.

The portfolio will avoid excessive animated interfaces.

12. Accessibility Requirements

Accessibility is a core design constraint.

The portfolio will support:

- dark-mode-first rendering;
- responsive resizing;
- accessibility-safe palettes by default;
- sufficient contrast between text and background;
- colourblind-safe chart alternatives;
- labels and annotations that do not rely on colour alone;
- keyboard-accessible interactive elements where feasible;
- readable captions and alternative explanations for complex visuals.

Charts and diagrams should remain understandable when exported statically.

13. Responsiveness

The portfolio will be desktop-first.

Desktop readability and chart inspection are priorities because the portfolio's main value lies in polished analytical visuals, systems diagrams, and project exploration.

However, the website should remain usable on mobile. Mobile layouts may simplify chart interaction, reduce grid density, and prioritize project summaries.

The mobile version does not need to reproduce the full desktop inspection experience, but it must not break readability or navigation.

14. Non-Goals

The portfolio will explicitly avoid the following:

- profile photos as a central design element;
- long autobiographical sections;
- skill-bar graphics;
- corporate stock visuals;
- generic AI-generated aesthetic visuals;
- excessive animation;
- empty bright-white sections;
- generic developer-portfolio tropes;
- inflated self-branding language;
- raw notebook interfaces presented as portfolio outputs.

The portfolio should not feel like a personal lifestyle page, a generic CV website, a consulting template, or a flashy AI-generated landing page.

15. Relationship Between Projects

The portfolio framework will remain independent from any single project.

The Remaster project may be the first and most developed project, but the website should be structured to accommodate other analytical, policy, automation, modelling, or visualisation projects.

No project should define the entire portfolio identity alone. The identity belongs to the broader analytical profile.

16. Governance Principles

Future additions to the portfolio should respect the following rules:

- each new project must have a clear analytical question;
- each project must show evidence of method, output, and interpretation;
- each visual must answer a specific question;
- charts should be polished rather than numerous;
- homepage content should remain curated;
- technical depth should be accessible but not overwhelming;
- design consistency should be preserved across pages.

The portfolio will evolve through controlled additions rather than constant redesign.

17. Summary of Fixed Design Decisions

Dimension	Decision
Primary audience	Recruiters, with technical credibility for specialists
Profile positioning	Hybrid analytical profile
Tone	Policy-institutional
Personal presence	Minimal and project-centric
Visual mood	Calm, elegant, dark-mode-first, institutional
Navigation	Card/grid project exploration
Homepage technical depth	Present but secondary
Visual priority	Networks, flows, systems diagrams, trajectories, policy scenarios
Chart philosophy	Few charts, highly polished
Interactivity	Selective, polished, public-facing
Device priority	Desktop-first
Portfolio scope	Independent from any single project